

Jonathan García Fuentes

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🔗 [jonathangarciaf.github.io](https://github.com/jonathangarciaf)

EDUCATION

- Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany** September 2026 (expected)
Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) *Supervisors:* Prof. Tilman Brück, Prof. Harald Grethe, and Prof. Andrea Guariso
Visiting Scholar, Cornell College of Human Ecology – Prof. John Hoddinott Fall 2025
- Georg-August-Universität Göttingen, Germany** October 2020
Master's of Science in Development Economics (M.Sc.). *Specialization:* Quantitative Economics.
- Università degli Studi di Torino, Italy** February 2019
Master's in Applied Labour Economics for Development (M.S.)
- Universidad Centroamericana (UCA), Nicaragua** May 2013
Bachelor of Science in Applied Economics (B.Sc.). *Minor:* Economic & Territorial Development.

EMPLOYMENT

- Zero Hunger Lab (IGZ & Humboldt University)** July 2023 – present
Research Fellow: Economic Development and Food Security Research Group - IGZ
– Impact Evaluation (cRCT): Testing Targeting Variants for Humanitarian Food Assistance in DRC. *Collaboration with WFP-Office of Evaluation (OEV) and WB's DIME. Report*
– Beneficiaries' preferences for food assistance. *Collaboration with WFP-OEV.*
– Horticulture Policy and Food Security (Systematic Review).
- International Security and Development Center (ISDC)** November 2023 – present
Research Affiliate: Impact Evaluation (RCT): Retargeting Humanitarian Food Assistance in Lebanon: A Nation-Wide Experiment.
Collaboration with WFP-OEV and WFP-CO Lebanon. Report
- Collaboration for International Development Economics Research (Cornell University)** May 2025 – present
Research Fellow: STARS Program
- United Nations World Institute for Development Economics Research (UNU-WIDER)** April – June 2025
Research (PhD) Fellow: Project, Optimizing Transfer Value in DRC: Household and Community Impact.
- United Nations World Food Program (WFP)** October 2020 – July 2023
Regional Bureau for Southern Africa | Regional Targeting & Research Officer June 2021 – June 2023
– Targeting and Assessment Advisor for **12 countries** (including DRC, Mozambique, Madagascar, Malawi, Zimbabwe, Lesotho, Tanzania, Angola), to reach **17 million** beneficiaries in the region.
– Led a multi-country impact evaluation (Rapid Rural Transformation) in Madagascar, Mozambique, and DRC.
– Co-coordinator of the Regional Urban Preparedness project (RUP, **€1 million**, financed by ECHO).
– Innovation focal, managing a **USD\$100,000** innovation fund with a focus on Earth Observation and AI.
- Cabo Delgado, Mozambique | Vulnerability-Based Targeting Coordinator** August – November 2021
– Designed and coordinated the first population registry and targeting system for **1.6 million** IDPs and host families.
- Sudan | Profiling, Targeting & Studies Coordinator** October 2020 – June 2021
– Design and implement assessments and targeting systems for WFP's **6 million** people operation.
- Leibniz Universität Hannover & German Institute for Economic Research (DIW)** June – October 2020
Research Assistant: RCT - "Financial Education, Mobile Money, and Small-scale Entrepreneurs in Uganda."
- Centre for Modern Indian Studies (CeMIS)** January 2019 – September 2020
Research Assistant: RCTs, quasi-experiments, and descriptive studies. January 2019 – September 2020
Field Coordinator: Impact evaluation of a new hospital. N=12,000 patient exit survey. September - October 2019
- United Nations World Food Program (WFP)** April 2019 – September 2018
Mozambique | RAM Officer December 2016 - June 2017
– Designed and implemented a monitoring system for a 1 million beneficiary emergency operations and led WFP's contribution to the first National Nutrition Survey (**3,000 HH**) and IPC Acute Malnutrition.
- Regional Bureau for Latin America | RAM Officer** April – December 2016
– Market assessments and price monitoring advisor for the region; Data manager post-earthquake food security assessment Ecuador.
- Nicaragua | Research, Assessment, and Monitoring (RAM) Associate** April 2014 – September 2018
– Support monitoring, market and impact assessments, and price monitoring for WFP's operation in Nicaragua.
- Consultants for Development S.A. (COPADES)** November 2012 - December 2013
Junior Economist: advising the input-output matrix base 2012 (Nicaragua's Central Bank), tax reform 2012 (National Council of Private Enterprise), and social security reform 2013 (National Institute of Pensions and Social Security).
- Research and Development Institute NITLAPAN, Research Assistant** September - November 2012
TECHO, Analysis & Data Coordinator "Census of Slums in the Pacific of Nicaragua." [Link](#) January - November 2012

RESEARCH

PhD Dissertation

- Testing Targeting Variants for Emergency Transfers. Statistical- vs. Community-based Targeting in Eastern DRC. *Joint work with Andrea Guariso, Felipe Dunsh, Marcus Holmlund, Jonas Heirman, and Kristen McCollum.* **Draft.**
- When Humanitarian Assistance Fades Out: Experimental Evidence from a Nation-Wide Program in Lebanon. *Joint work with Ghassan Baliki, Felipe Dunsh, and Andrea Guariso.* **Draft**
- Optimizing Transfer Value in DRC. *Joint work with Aysha Twose*
- Beneficiaries' Preferences for Humanitarian Food Assistance Design. Three Discrete Choice Experiments in DRC.

Peer-PhD Work

- The Impacts of a New General Hospital on Waiting Time and Out-of-Pocket Expenditure for Outpatient Care. **Draft**
- Predictors of patients' choice and pathways of access to hospitals under universal health coverage: a case study of the Nicaraguan capital. *BMC Health Services Research* 2021. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12913-021-07333-z>
- Socio-economic predictors of adolescent marriage and maternity in West and Central Africa between 1986 and 2017. *J Glob Health* 2021; <https://doi.org/10.7189/jogh.11.13002>
- Levels and trends of adolescent marriage and maternity in West and Central Africa, 1986-2017. *J Glob Health* 2021; <https://doi.org/10.7189/jogh.11.13001>
- The Gender Pay Gap: Triple penalty? Woman, mother, and informal. Evidence from Nicaragua. *Revista de Economía y Finanzas*, Vol. 7. Central Bank of Nicaragua. **PDF Spanish Original (English) Code Best paper 2020, BCN**

FELLOWSHIPS, SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

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| ▪ Joachim Herz Add-on Fellowship for Interdisciplinary Economics. €12,500 | 2024-2026 |
| ▪ WFP's Innovation Award for developing a drought forecast model for Southern Africa. US\$100,000 | 2021 |
| ▪ Economy, Finance, and Development Award. 1 st place, research award. Nicaragua's Central Bank. US\$4,000 | 2020 |
| ▪ DAAD-EPOS Programme Scholarship for Graduate Studies in Development Economics. €35,000. | 2018 |
| ▪ MALED Scholarship for Graduate Studies in Labor Economics by ILO and University of Turin. €7,000. | 2017 |
| ▪ Academic Excellence Award, Universidad Centroamericana, Applied Economics. 2013. | 2013 |
| ▪ Young Researchers, Universidad Centroamericana - Nicaragua. 3 rd place. | 2012 |
| ▪ Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies in Applied Economics, 2009-2013. Universidad Centroamericana. | 2009 |
| ▪ Bronze medallist with Nicaragua's national basketball team (U15 and U17), Central American Championship. | 2007 |

TEACHING

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin - Germany

July 2023 - present

- *Teaching Assistant (Graduate):* • Economics of Rural Development

Georg-August-Universität Göttingen - Germany

January 2019 – September 2020

- *Teaching Assistant (Graduate):* • Development Economics III • Poverty & inequality

Universidad Centroamericana (UCA) - Nicaragua

February 2010 – December 2013

- *Lecturer (Undergraduate):* • Macroeconomic Accounts • Business Economics.
- *Teaching Assistant (Graduate):* • Econometrics I and Statistical Inference. • Mathematics I, II and III.

CONFERENCES, LECTURES & INVITED TALKS

2025 WIDER Conference (*UNU-WIDER*); CSAE 2025 (*Oxford University*); LEADS (Bremen).

2024 Leibniz Research Network CrisEn (Berlin); German Economic Association (VfS).

Panelist: -Forgotten Conflicts, join with Prof. Martin Gassebner, and Prof. Anna Minasyan (*U. of Göttingen*); Food Security and Conflicts, with Johan Swinnen, Lukas Kornher, and Bettina Rudlof. IAMO Forum, (*Halle*).

2023 *Panelist:* Are we on track Zero Hunger? with Prof. Meike Wollni and Margherita Squarcina (*U of Göttingen*); *Invited lecture:* Poverty and food insecurity measurement and targeting (*Technische Universität München*)

2022-2019 *Panelist:* Evidence and evaluation in humanitarian contexts (*SAMEA, Johannesburg*); *Invited lecturer:* Targeting the ultra-poor; Measuring food insecurity (*Technische Universität München*); DAAD annual meeting (*Universität Hamburg*).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software & Programming

- *Stats./GIS/Data Vis.:* STATA, R, Ngene, Gi, ArcGIS, TABLEAU. ▪ *Survey:* ODK, SurveyCTO ▪ *Text:* LaTeX, M. Office.

Languages

- *Native:* Spanish ▪ *Fluent:* English, Portuguese, and Italian. ▪ *Intermediate:* German (B1) and French (B1).